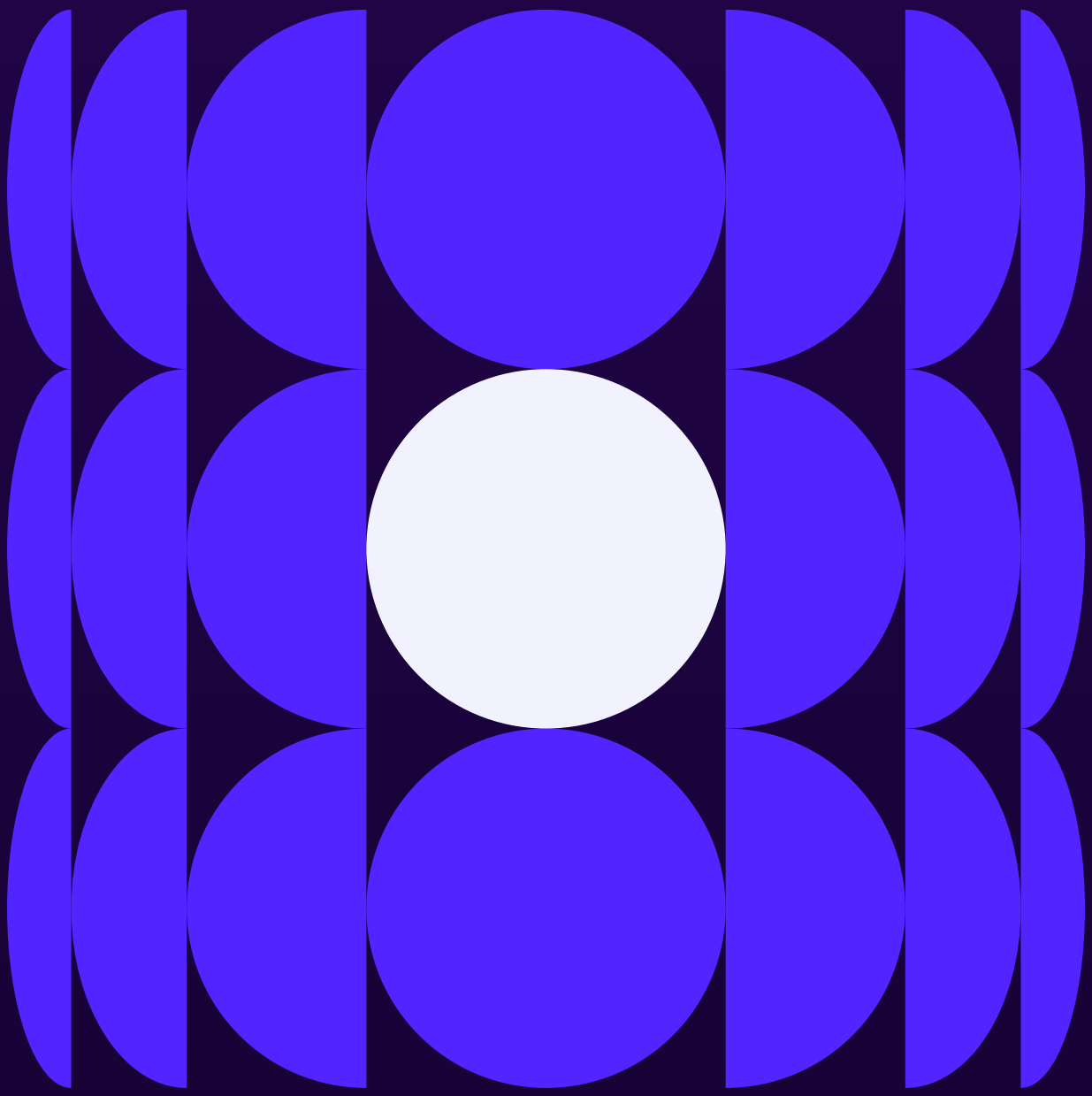
SiteScanly

5 Simple Tweaks to Speed Up Your Website



sitescanly.com

Introduction

A fast website feels calm. Pages appear quickly, buttons respond instantly, and visitors do not have to wait or wonder whether something is broken. For small businesses, that matters because slow sites quietly cost enquiries. People leave, forms get abandoned, and even loyal customers feel less confident.

The good news is that you rarely need a rebuild to see improvements. Most slowdowns come from a handful of repeat offenders: oversized images, too many scripts, heavy fonts, and missing caching. This short ebook gives you five simple tweaks you can apply today, even if you are not technical.

In this guide, we will cover:

01 Optimising your images

02 Removing heavy scripts

03 Tidying your typography

04 Turning on caching and compression

05 Simplifying ‘above the fold’ content

01

Optimising images

Images are often the heaviest part of a page. A single large photo can outweigh all your text and styling combined, especially if it was uploaded straight from a phone or a designer's export.

What to do:

1. Resize before you upload: if an image only displays at 1200px wide, do not upload a 4000px version.
2. Compress files: aim for clear, not perfect. Most people cannot tell the difference after compression.
3. Use modern formats: WebP (or AVIF) loads faster than PNG or JPEG.
4. Keep galleries sensible: ten huge images on one page will always feel slow.
5. Avoid 'decorative' images that add weight but do not add meaning.

How to do it:

- Use tools like Squoosh, TinyPNG, or your Mac/Windows export options.
- For photos, try quality around 60–80% and compare side by side.
- For logos, ask for an SVG version. It stays crisp and is usually tiny.

Why it helps

Browsers must download images before a page feels complete. Smaller files mean faster downloads, quicker painting, and less data used for mobile visitors.

Quick checklist

- [ ] No hero image larger than it needs to be (check displayed size).
- [ ] Most photos are under 200 KB where possible.
- [ ] Logos and icons are SVG or compressed PNG.
- [ ] Image format is WebP or AVIF where supported.
- [ ] Lazy loading is enabled for images below the first screen.

Easy test

After updating images, rerun PageSpeed Insights. If you see fewer 'properly size images' or 'serve images in next-gen formats' warnings, you are moving in the right direction.

02

Removing heavy scripts

Many websites load extra code from third parties: chat widgets, pop-ups, cookie tools, booking systems, social feeds, embedded maps, and multiple analytics tags. Each one may be useful, but together they can slow the site and make it feel 'jittery' as things load in.

What to do:

Start by listing everything that adds code to your pages:

- Analytics (Google, Meta, LinkedIn, etc)
- Tag managers
- Chat or chatbot tools
- Booking or payment widgets
- Embedded maps or social feeds

How to find them quickly:

- Your speed report often lists third-party domains in 'Diagnostics'.
- Ask your web person: "Which scripts load on every page, and which can be removed?"

Why it helps

Every script competes for your visitor's device, especially on cheaper mobiles. Fewer scripts means less to download and less work for the browser.

Quick checklist

- [ ] No duplicate analytics tags.
- [ ] Only one chat tool, and only if it is genuinely monitored.
- [ ] Social feeds are optional, not essential.
- [ ] Map embeds are replaced with a link unless they are critical.
- [ ] You have removed at least one unnecessary script.

Easy test

Retest your site. If your speed report mentions 'reduce unused JavaScript' or 'third-party code blocked the main thread', those warnings should reduce after a tidy-up.

03

Tidying your typography

Custom fonts look lovely, but they can be expensive. Each font family, style, and weight is a separate file that must be downloaded before text can display properly. If your site uses three fonts with four weights each, you might be asking the browser to fetch a dozen extra files.

How to spot font bloat:

- Your speed report may mention 'web fonts' or show a long list of font files.
- If headings, menus, and buttons all look slightly different.

What to do

1. Use fewer fonts: one primary font and one accent font is plenty.
2. Use fewer weights: try regular (400) and bold (700) only.
3. Avoid 'thin' weights on mobile. They can look faint and often add extra downloads.
4. If you can, host fonts locally rather than pulling them from Google Fonts or other places.

Why it helps

When fonts load slowly, you get blank text, shifting layouts, or a page that feels unfinished. Reducing fonts makes pages feel stable and quick, even before the last pixels have finished loading.

Simple settings that help

- Enable 'font-display: swap' so text shows immediately, then improves when the font loads.
- Preconnect to the font provider if you must load from a third party.

Quick checklist

- [ ] No more than 2 font families on the whole site.
- [ ] No more than 2 weights per font.
- [ ] Heading styles reuse the same weights, not lots of variations.
- [ ] 'Swap' is enabled so text appears quickly.
- [ ] You have retested and seen fewer font-related warnings.

Easy test

Retest your site and hopefully you will see fewer reports of font issues.

04

Turning on caching and compression

Caching is your website's way of saying: "You have already downloaded this, so I will not make you do it again." When caching is set up well, repeat visits are much faster, and even first visits can improve because files are delivered more efficiently. Compression is similar. It squeezes your files in transit so they download quicker, especially on mobile connections.

What to do

1. Ask your host or web person to enable browsing caching for images, CSS and Javascript.
2. Also ask your host or web person to enable compression with Brotli or Gzip
3. If you use a service like Cloudflare, many of these options are simple switches in the dashboard.

What to look for

- Your speed report may mention 'enable text compression' or 'serve static assets with an efficient cache policy'.
- If your site feels slow every time you visit, caching is often missing or misconfigured.

Why it helps

Without caching, visitors repeatedly download the same files on every page and every visit. With caching, the browser reuses what it already has, so pages feel snappy and stable.

Quick checklist

- [ ] Compression is enabled (Brotli or Gzip).
- [ ] Images, fonts, CSS, and JS have sensible cache times.
- [ ] A CDN is enabled if your host offers one.
- [ ] The site still updates correctly after changes (cache is not 'stuck').
- [ ] You have retested and seen fewer caching or compression warnings.

Easy test

Open your website in an incognito/private window on your phone. Visit three pages (for example: Home, Services, Contact). Notice how quickly each page appears. Now tap back to a page you have already visited. It should feel faster the second time. If nothing feels faster on repeat visits, ask your host/web person: "Can you confirm browser caching and compression are enabled, and tell me what changed?"

05

Simplifying ‘above the fold’ content

The top section of your page, what visitors see first, does a lot of heavy lifting. It is also where many sites accidentally become slow: autoplay videos, sliders, giant background images, animated effects, and several call-to-action blocks stacked together. If the first screen is heavy, visitors feel the slowdown immediately, even if the rest of the page is fine.

What to do

1. Replace autoplay video backgrounds with a still image and a clear play button.
2. Avoid sliders. A single strong message usually converts better and loads faster.
3. Limit animations and parallax effects, especially on mobile.
4. Keep the first screen focused: headline, short supporting line, one primary button.

Simple swaps

- Use a compressed hero image instead of a full-width video.
- Move non-essential sections (testimonials, logos, big galleries) further down the page.
- Use an embedded video only when someone clicks ‘play’.

Why it helps

Your visitor’s device can start rendering the page sooner, with less to download and fewer moving parts. The page feels quicker, even if the total load time only improves a little.

Quick checklist

- [ ] No autoplay video on the homepage.
- [ ] No sliders or carousels unless absolutely necessary.
- [ ] Animations are subtle and do not block scrolling.
- [ ] The first screen has one clear goal and one main button.
- [ ] You have retested and the ‘largest contentful paint’ warning is reduced.

Easy test

Open your homepage on your phone using mobile data (turn Wi-Fi off). Start a timer as you tap the link. Stop the timer when you can read the main headline and tap the main button. If the headline or button appears late, or the layout shifts, reduce what loads in the first screen (swap video for an image, remove sliders, and move heavy sections further down).

SiteScanly

Interested in a monthly website health report?

Go to sitescanly.com

sitescanly.com